



Troubleshooting playbook

Fix smart-home failures fast using flowcharts

Smart homes don't "break." They drift—a router reboots, a battery sensor sleeps longer, a cloud skill logs out, a Thread border router quietly goes offline. The good news: 90% of failures repeat the same patterns. Your job is to diagnose in the right order, so you don't factory-reset perfectly innocent devices.

This chapter gives you two core flowcharts:

1. Device offline ladder (power → network → hub → app)
2. Automation didn't trigger ladder (trigger → condition → action → platform logs)

...and then quick "protocol drills" for Wi-Fi, Zigbee, Thread/Matter, plus voice assistants.

The 60-second triage (before you touch anything)

Step 1: Is it one device or many?

- Many devices offline at once → it's almost always power/router/hub.
- One device offline → power, battery, range, or that device's firmware.